

RESOLVE MUN 2026

BACKGROUND GUIDE

CONTINUOUS CRISIS COMMITTEE

Agenda

Freeze Date : 12 July, 2026

Executive Board
Bhawesh Kushwaha
Krish
Sarvasv

Letter from the Executive Board

Dear Delegates,

We welcome you to The Continuous Crisis Committee (CCC) for Resolve MUN 2026!! As members of the CCC, you will have to discuss the following agenda

This background guide is not to be treated as exhaustive research on the agenda, but instead just as an effort to provide a short yet comprehensive description of the committee and the nuances within the agenda. We encourage and expect each delegate to explore topics/aspects of the agenda not covered within this guide.

Regarding the topics mentioned in this guide, we request delegates to treat them as a starting point for their research.

The following sources of information will be deemed credible during this conference:

- 1) Reuters
- 2) Reports published by any: body/committee/affiliated body of the United Nations
- 3) Statistics and data reported by certain credible NGOs or statistical organisations
- 4) Any other source the Executive Board may deem admissible during committee

The Executive Board intends to follow the Rules of Procedures enacted in the UNA-USA format, with variations per the committee's needs.

The Executive Board will not intervene in the flow of debate and the matter being discussed in committee. Our primary responsibility shall always remain moderating and ensuring equitable marking. Therefore, it falls upon the delegates themselves to ensure qualitative debate in the committee. Good research and enthusiastic participation is all we request from you. Please do not hesitate to contact the Executive Board before or during the conference if you have any queries about the agenda or the rules of procedure.

We look forward to an exciting and thoughtful debate for these 3 days!

With Warm Regards,

Bhawesh Kushwaha – Chairperson

Krish – Vice-Chairperson

Sarvasv – Rapporteur

Executive Board,

Continuous Crisis Committee

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I. Global Background — A World in Polycrisis

Note: Everything in this guide reflects the world as it stands on July 12, 2026. Anything that happens after that date will be introduced by the EB as live crisis updates during committee. Think of July 12 as the moment you step into the simulation.

As of July 12, 2026, the world is in a difficult place, and not just because of one conflict or one crisis. What makes this so unusual, and what makes this committee so challenging, is that multiple serious problems are happening at the same time, and they are all feeding into each other. Analysts call this a "polycrisis."

The term was popularised by historian Adam Tooze and the World Economic Forum. It simply means that when crises overlap and amplify each other, the total damage is worse than any one of them would cause alone. Crises do not wait for each other to end. They collide.

The international system - the United Nations, international law, global trade rules - was designed for a world where problems could be addressed one at a time. That system is under serious strain right now. Trust in global institutions is at a historic low, and more and more countries are choosing to act unilaterally or in small alliances rather than working through multilateral channels.

1.1 Operation Epic Fury and the 2026 Iran Conflict

The single biggest event driving this committee is the 2026 Iran Conflict, commonly referred to as Operation Epic Fury. On February 28, 2026, the United States and Israel launched a large, coordinated military operation against Iran. The targets included Iran's nuclear facilities, ballistic missile production sites, military command centres, and senior leadership.

The strikes were built on years of Israeli intelligence work inside Iran. They used a combination of US long-range air power, naval cruise missiles, Israeli fighter jets, and reportedly cyberattacks on Iranian air defences. The goals were twofold: permanently set back Iran's nuclear weapons programme, which the IAEA had assessed in late 2025 as having crossed critical enrichment thresholds, and cripple the command structure of the IRGC (Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps), which manages Iran's network of regional proxy groups.

The operation achieved significant results. Several top Iranian officials were killed, including Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei, the most dramatic political upheaval in Iran since the Islamic Republic was founded in 1979. Key nuclear sites at Natanz, Fordow, and Isfahan were severely damaged. The Quds Force, which is the IRGC unit responsible for arming Hezbollah, Hamas, and the Houthis, lost much of its leadership.

In response, Iran launched ballistic missiles and drones at Israeli cities, at US military bases in Iraq, Qatar, and Bahrain, and at shipping in and around the Strait of Hormuz. Iranian naval forces mined the Strait and attacked tankers with fast boats — the first time Hormuz had been mined on this scale since the 1980s. Iran invoked Article 51 of the UN Charter, calling the strikes an act of aggression. The US and Israel countered that they were acting in pre-emptive self-defence, citing Iran's nuclear programme and its proxy attacks on their forces.

A fragile ceasefire was brokered in April 2026, facilitated quietly by Oman and Qatar. But it has not held cleanly. Naval skirmishes between US and Iranian forces continue in the Gulf. The Strait of Hormuz is technically open, but shipping insurance costs remain extremely high and several major companies are still routing vessels around the Cape of Good Hope, adding 10 to 14 days to journeys and significantly higher costs.

Inside Iran, Mojtaba Khamenei, son of the late Supreme Leader has emerged as the dominant political figure, though his position is contested. He is navigating intense internal factional competition while leading a country dealing with infrastructure destruction, economic collapse, and real questions about the Islamic Republic's future. The conflict did not produce the swift political transformation that some in Washington had hoped for. What it did produce were consequences, economic, humanitarian, diplomatic, that are still spreading outward.

1.2 Pre-Existing Crises: The World Before Epic Fury

Operation Epic Fury did not erupt into a peaceful world. It erupted into a world that was already on fire in several places at once. Understanding these pre-existing crises matters because the Iran conflict has made each of them worse in its own way.

Sudan is, by almost every measure, the world's largest humanitarian catastrophe right now. The civil war between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF), led by General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan, and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF), led by General Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo, known as Hemedti, entered its fourth year in April 2026. What started as a power struggle between two military factions has become something far more devastating: mass atrocities in Darfur, widespread famine, cholera outbreaks, and the deliberate destruction of civilian infrastructure. The UN Special Adviser on the Prevention of Genocide has warned that the situation in Darfur bears "the hallmarks of genocide." Approximately over 10 to 12 million people have been displaced - a number that, by some measures, surpasses even Ukraine. External actors have made it worse, the UAE has reportedly been supplying the RSF, Egypt backs the SAF, and Russia's Africa Corps (the rebranded Wagner Group) operates in the background. Every mediation attempt so far has failed.

The Russia-Ukraine War, now in its fifth year, continues as a grinding attritional conflict. Russia holds approximately 20% of Ukrainian territory, including most of Donetsk, Luhansk, Zaporizhzhia, and Kherson oblasts. Russian missiles and drones regularly strike Ukrainian energy infrastructure and cities. Ukraine strikes back deep inside Russian territory using domestically built and Western-supplied drones. The International Criminal Court issued an arrest warrant for President Putin in 2023 for the unlawful deportation of Ukrainian children - a case that is still ongoing. Multiple ceasefire attempts have been announced and quickly violated. The war keeps draining European resources, disrupting global grain and fertiliser markets, and deepening the divide between the Western alliance and the Russia-China axis.

In Myanmar, the post-2021 coup civil war has entered a phase of significant territorial change. The military junta, called the State Administration Council (SAC) is facing coordinated offensives from a coalition of Ethnic Armed Organisations (EAOs) and the People's Defence Force (PDF), which is the armed wing of the civilian government in exile. Operation 1027, launched by the Three Brotherhood Alliance in late 2023, showed that the junta could be pushed back significantly. By mid-2026, the SAC still holds major cities but has effectively lost control of large parts of Shan, Chin, Sagaing, and Rakhine states. The human cost has been enormous, over 2 million people displaced internally, and hundreds of thousands of Rohingya refugees still stranded in Bangladesh, having fled the 2017 ethnic cleansing that the UN described as bearing the hallmarks of genocide.

Venezuela remains in a state of national emergency following a dramatic U.S. special operations raid in Caracas that captured former President Nicolás Maduro. Vice President Delcy Rodríguez has been sworn in as interim president, while the nation struggles with widespread poverty and ongoing instability following the regime's collapse.

Across the Middle East, Iran's network of proxy groups, Hezbollah in Lebanon, Hamas in Gaza, the Houthis in Yemen, and Shia militias in Iraq, has been weakened but not broken by Operation Epic Fury. The Houthis continue to attack shipping in the Red Sea and Gulf of Aden, pushing global container traffic away from the Suez Canal route. Hezbollah opened a second front against Israel during the conflict's peak and took serious damage, but still holds significant military capacity and political influence in Lebanon. Hamas in Gaza operates under a fragile ceasefire that both sides keep testing. Syria remains a fractured state with Russian, Iranian (now weakened), Turkish, and American forces all present, while its civilian population faces what is approaching fifteen years of continuous displacement and suffering.

1.3 Economic and Financial Dimensions

The economic impact of all this, especially the Iran conflict, has been severe and uneven, hitting vulnerable countries the hardest.

The Strait of Hormuz disruption is the largest shock to global oil markets since the 1973 Arab oil embargo. At its worst, Iranian mining, tanker attacks, insurance withdrawal, and rerouting decisions reduced Hormuz transits by an estimated 30% to 50% for several weeks. Even after partial normalisation, the effects linger. Brent crude, which was around \$78 per barrel in January 2026, surged to \$127 in late March before settling back to a still-elevated \$94 to \$102 range after the April ceasefire. For countries that import their energy, India, Japan, South Korea, China, Bangladesh, Pakistan, Nigeria, and most of Africa, this translates directly into higher fuel costs, inflation, and ballooning trade deficits.

Global growth for 2026 has been revised down across the board. The IMF projects around 2.7 to 3.1%, well below the 3.6% pre-pandemic average and the third consecutive year of below-trend growth. The risks are skewed to the downside: another Hormuz escalation, an emerging market financial crisis, or a significant deterioration in Ukraine could push things into outright recession. Countries like Pakistan, Nigeria, Bangladesh, Lebanon, and Egypt are already in acute debt distress, with depleted reserves and limited access to international capital. Governments have responded with fuel subsidies and emergency spending, but that only piles more pressure on already-strained public finances.

De-dollarisation, the gradual shift away from using the US dollar in international trade, is real, even if it is often overstated. China's alternative payment system (CIPS), currency swap deals between China and Gulf states, and Iran-Russia trade that bypasses SWIFT are chipping away at dollar dominance. None of this is about to collapse the dollar's reserve currency status, but the direction is clear and has long-term implications for America's ability to use financial sanctions as a foreign policy lever.

1.4 Climate, Migration, and Transnational Threats

The polycrisis is not just about wars and markets. Several slower-moving forces are running in the background, making everything else harder to manage.

Climate change is acting as a threat multiplier. A La Nina weather pattern established in 2025 has driven below-average rainfall across the Sahel, Horn of Africa, and South Asia, worsening food insecurity in places already destabilised by conflict. Extreme heat in South Asia and the Middle East has pushed outdoor conditions past liveable thresholds for workers. Flooding in Bangladesh, Pakistan, and Myanmar has compounded displacement. The UN's Food and Agriculture Organisation identified 18 countries in June 2026 as facing acute food crises needing emergency intervention, with Sudan, Yemen, Gaza, Haiti, and parts of the DRC and Ethiopia at the most severe levels.

Displacement has hit a record high. UNHCR's mid-2026 figures anticipates over 130 million forcibly displaced and stateless people worldwide, more than double the figure from a decade ago. Sudan alone accounts for approximately over 12 million of that total. The pressure of hosting large refugee populations is reshaping domestic politics in Turkey, Lebanon, Bangladesh, Uganda, and Colombia, fuelling nativist sentiment and straining public services.

Cyber threats are now inseparable from conventional conflict. The Iran War involved significant cyberattacks on Iranian nuclear controls, power infrastructure, and communications, widely attributed to US Cyber Command and Israel's Unit 8200, and Iranian-attributed retaliatory attacks on Gulf financial institutions and Israeli water systems. Russian cyber operations against Ukraine and Europe continue. AI-enabled warfare - autonomous drone swarms, AI-assisted targeting, algorithmic disinformation - has made its real-world debut across several theatres, raising questions that the Geneva Conventions and the Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons (CCW) are not yet equipped to fully answer.

Nuclear risks are at their highest since the Cold War ended. Iran's nuclear facilities were damaged but the programme almost certainly survives in some form, and the incentive to reconstitute it, or even pursue weaponisation as a deterrent, has arguably increased after the strikes. North Korea continues to advance its ICBM and warhead miniaturisation capabilities. India and Pakistan remain nuclear-armed rivals with a contested border in Kashmir and periodic escalatory incidents. The NPT's review conferences keep failing to produce consensus, and the Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons, which entered into force in 2021, has only been signed by non-nuclear states — leaving the disarmament architecture weaker than it has ever been.

Terrorism has not gone away either. ISIS affiliates in the Sahel, Iraq-Syria corridor, and Southeast Asia continue to operate. ISIS-K in Afghanistan-Pakistan conducts high-casualty attacks. In the Sahel, both al-Qaeda-affiliated JNIM and ISIS groups are

expanding their reach following the withdrawal of French and Western forces from Mali, Burkina Faso, and Niger.

1.5 Why Linkages Are Everything

None of these crises exists in isolation. When the Strait of Hormuz is disrupted, energy importers like India, Japan, South Korea, and China feel the pain within days. Those higher fuel costs hit Bangladesh's garment industry (which depends on imported yarn and fuel) and Nigeria's import-dependent economy, sparking inflation and political unrest. That instability pulls the attention of regional bodies like ECOWAS and the African Union away from the Sudan mediation they are supposed to be managing. Meanwhile, donor fatigue in Western capitals, governments already stretched by Ukraine support and domestic energy costs, shrinks the humanitarian funding flowing to Sudan, Yemen, and Myanmar. Worsening conditions on the ground produce more displacement. More displacement strains host countries. Strained host countries become more vulnerable to destabilisation by non-state actors - jihadist groups, criminal networks, arms traffickers - who thrive wherever governance is weak.

These are not hypothetical scenarios. This is what 2026 actually looks like. As a delegate, if you try to manage the Iran crisis without thinking about Hormuz economics, or treat Sudan as separate from Gulf power competition, the world will not cooperate with that framing. The most effective work in this committee will come from delegates who think about second and third-order effects, find leverage across multiple crises at once, and build solutions grounded in genuinely shared interests.

1.6 The UN and Multilateral Architecture Under Strain

The UN Security Council, which under Chapter VII of the UN Charter holds primary responsibility for international peace and security, has been effectively paralysed throughout the crises of 2026. The P5 veto system, designed in 1945 to keep the great powers invested in collective security, has instead become a mechanism that immunises conflicts from international accountability. Russia and China have used their vetoes to shield Iran. China has shielded Russia over Ukraine. The US has shielded Israel. The result is that the body most responsible for managing the world's worst crises has been unable to pass binding resolutions on any of them.

The General Assembly has been more active, passing non-binding resolutions condemning the Iran strikes and calling for ceasefires in Sudan and Ukraine, but without any enforcement mechanism, these carry limited practical weight and not of any major use at the end of the day. UN agencies like the WFP, UNHCR, OCHA, and WHO continue doing essential humanitarian work under conditions of chronic underfunding and

access denial. The IAEA is still engaged with what it can access of Iran's nuclear programme, but inspectors have been expelled from several key facilities. The International Criminal Court has active proceedings related to Ukraine, Sudan, and Gaza, but faces non-cooperation from the very parties it is investigating, and an ongoing legitimacy dispute with the United States, which is not an ICC member.

The uncomfortable reality is that the multilateral architecture built after World War II was not designed for a world in which all three of its most powerful veto-wielding states are simultaneously parties to or active patrons of ongoing armed conflicts. Reforming that architecture is a long-term project. Dealing with the consequences of its current dysfunction is the immediate challenge in front of this committee.

II. Timeline of the Polycrisis

Key events leading to July 12, 2026

Events between June 12 and July 12, 2026 will be introduced by the EB as live crisis updates during committee sessions. Delegates are expected to research the broader context of each crisis independently, this timeline gives you the idea, not the full picture.

February 1, 2021 Myanmar's military launches a coup against the elected government of Aung San Suu Kyi. Mass protests are met with a brutal crackdown. The National Unity Government and People's Defence Force are established in opposition. A civil war begins that will grind on for years.

February 24, 2022 Russia launches a full-scale invasion of Ukraine, triggering the largest land war in Europe since World War II. The West responds with sweeping sanctions. Global grain and energy markets are immediately disrupted - Russia and Ukraine supply roughly 28% of global wheat exports. Over 8 million Ukrainians eventually flee abroad.

Late 2022 Ukraine's military, armed with Western weapons, halts Russian advances and retakes significant territory in Kharkiv and Kherson. Europe scrambles to replace Russian gas with LNG imports from the Gulf, US, and Norway, accelerating a structural shift in global energy trade.

April 15, 2023 Civil war erupts in Sudan between the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) under General Abdel Fattah al-Burhan and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) under General Mohamed Hamdan Dagalo, known as Hemedti. Fighting breaks out simultaneously in Khartoum and Darfur. What begins as a power struggle between two military factions rapidly becomes a catastrophic humanitarian crisis. Reports of mass atrocities and ethnic targeting emerge from Darfur almost immediately. The UAE backs the RSF; Egypt backs the SAF; Russia's Africa Corps (the rebranded Wagner Group) operates in the background. Every mediation attempt fails.

October 7, 2023 Hamas launches Operation Al-Aqsa Flood - the largest attack on Israeli soil since 1948. Around 1,200 Israelis are killed and 253 taken hostage. Israel declares war and launches a massive ground and air campaign in Gaza. Hezbollah opens a low-intensity second front on Israel's northern border. The UN Security Council is immediately deadlocked on the conflict.

November 2023 Houthi forces in Yemen begin attacking commercial shipping in the Red Sea, declaring vessels linked to Israel as legitimate targets. Major shipping companies divert away from the Suez Canal route within weeks, beginning a prolonged disruption to global trade.

January 2024 The US and UK launch airstrikes on Houthi military infrastructure in Yemen under Operation Prosperity Guardian. The attacks degrade Houthi capabilities but do not stop the Red Sea campaign. The Houthis demonstrate the ability to rapidly reconstitute and continue striking.

April 2024 Iran launches its first-ever direct missile and drone attack on Israeli territory - over 300 projectiles fired in retaliation for an Israeli strike on the Iranian consulate in Damascus. Israel intercepts the vast majority with US, UK, French, and Jordanian assistance. Israel conducts a limited retaliatory strike on Iranian air defences. The direct exchange sets a dangerous new precedent.

September - October 2024 Israel escalates sharply against Hezbollah. A series of operations - including coordinated explosions of Hezbollah communications devices that kill and wound thousands - are followed by the assassination of Secretary-General Hassan Nasrallah in a Beirut airstrike on September 27. Israel launches a ground incursion into southern Lebanon. A US-France brokered ceasefire halts the operation in October, calling for implementation of UN Security Council Resolution 1701, which had never been properly enforced since 2006.

November 2024 Donald Trump wins the US presidential election. His return to office signals a harder line on Iran, unconditional support for Israel, a transactional approach to NATO, and a focus on ending the Ukraine war on terms broadly acceptable to Russia.

January 20, 2025 Trump is inaugurated. Maximum pressure sanctions on Iran are immediately reimposed and expanded. US military assets begin a quiet build-up in the Gulf region. Trump signals he will not rule out military action to prevent Iranian nuclear breakout.

March 2025 A Gaza ceasefire and hostage deal is finalised after months of Qatari, Egyptian, and US mediation. The deal secures the release of remaining living hostages but leaves Gaza's governance and reconstruction entirely unresolved. Hamas retains organisational coherence despite heavy military losses.

Mid-2025 Western intelligence services assess with high confidence that Iran has achieved nuclear breakout capability - the ability to produce enough weapons-grade uranium for at least one weapon within a short timeframe. Israel formally notifies Washington that it considers this a red line requiring action. Emergency diplomatic efforts by European governments to revive a JCPOA-style framework collapse when Iran demands full sanctions removal as a precondition.

September 2025 Trump and Netanyahu meet at the White House. Publicly, the meeting reaffirms alliance ties. Privately, operational discussions about military options against Iran take place. Trump authorises expanded intelligence sharing and the pre-positioning of additional US military assets in the region.

December 2025 The diplomatic window closes entirely. US and Israeli military planners finalise the operational plan for what will become Operation Epic Fury.

February 28, 2026 Operation Epic Fury begins. US B-2 stealth bombers, F-35s, Navy Tomahawk missiles, and Israeli aircraft launch coordinated strikes across Iran targeting nuclear facilities at Natanz, Fordow, and Isfahan; ballistic missile production sites; IRGC command centres; and air defence systems. Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei is killed. The strikes are the most extensive US combat operation in the Middle East since the 2003 Iraq invasion.

March 1 - 15, 2026 Iran retaliates across multiple fronts simultaneously. Ballistic missiles and drones strike Israeli cities and US military bases in Iraq, Qatar, and Bahrain. Iranian naval units mine the Strait of Hormuz and attack commercial tankers - the first large-scale Hormuz mining since the 1980s tanker wars. Lloyd's of London suspends Hormuz insurance coverage. Hezbollah launches its largest-ever rocket barrage into northern Israel. Iraqi militias attack US bases and the Baghdad embassy. Houthi missiles strike US naval vessels in the Red Sea. Brent crude surges from \$78 to \$127 per barrel within two weeks.

March 2026 Two additional US carrier strike groups deploy to the region. Israel conducts follow-on strikes against Iranian missile reconstitution sites and, later, targets in Lebanon. Global shipping companies formally reroute all vessels away from the Gulf and Red Sea. The Cape of Good Hope diversion adds 10 to 14 days and significant costs to each voyage. Inflation spikes in energy-importing nations. Pakistan, Bangladesh, and Nigeria announce emergency economic measures.

April 2026 A ceasefire understanding is reached through Omani and Qatari mediation. Direct US-Israeli strikes on Iran and direct Iranian missile attacks on Israel and US bases halt. Proxy groups publicly refuse to consider themselves bound by the agreement. Houthi attacks continue in the Red Sea. Mojtaba Khamenei consolidates power in Tehran amid factional competition. In Sudan, famine is formally declared in four regions - the first in Africa since Somalia in 2011. Displaced persons surpass 12 million. El Fasher remains under RSF siege.

May 2026 Oil prices stabilise at \$94 to \$102 per barrel but insurance premiums remain elevated. The IMF revises global growth projections down to 2.7 to 3.1% for 2026. Emergency programmes are expanded for Pakistan, Egypt, and Nigeria. In Ukraine, a brief US-pressured ceasefire is announced and quickly violated. European NATO members pledge to increase their support for Kyiv as US commitment wavers. In Myanmar, the Arakan Army completes its capture of most of Rakhine State including the port of Sittwe, the junta's most significant territorial loss since 2021.

RULES OF PROCEDURE

Rules of Procedure (ROPs) provide an overview of the essential rules followed during MUN simulations. In simple terms, MUN committees follow a structured set of procedures to ensure smooth and organized debate.

Roll Call

- At the beginning of every session, the Chairperson calls all Member States in alphabetical order to confirm attendance.
- Delegates may respond with:
 - **“Present”**
 - **“Present and Voting”**

Delegates choosing “Present and Voting” cannot abstain during substantive voting.

Quorum

- Quorum is the minimum number of delegates required to begin the meeting and conduct committee business.
- For a General Assembly meeting to begin, at least **one-third (1/3rd)** of Member States must be present.
- Quorum is verified during Roll Call.

Voting Quorum

- A **simple majority** is required to pass procedural motions.
- Simple majority = **($\frac{1}{2} + 1$)** of Member States present.

Motion to Move into Formal Session

Verbatim:

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to move into a formal session.”

Agenda Setting

Agenda setting is the first major action of the committee. Before debate begins, delegates must decide the order in which topics will be discussed.

Usually, the committee decides whether **Agenda 1** or **Agenda 2** should be discussed first.

The motion requires a **simple majority** to pass.

Motion to Set the Agenda

Verbatims:

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to set Agenda 1.”

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to set Agenda 2 over Agenda 1.”

Note:

By default, the first agenda listed is considered first. Therefore, if a delegate wishes to discuss another agenda first, they must specify “over Agenda 1.”

Motion to Establish the General Speakers List (GSL)

Verbatims:

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to establish a General Speakers List.”

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to establish a General Speakers List with individual speaker’s time being _____ seconds.”

Note:

- Common GSL speaking times:
 - 60 seconds
 - 90 seconds
 - 120 seconds
- 90 seconds is generally considered the default time.

Debate

There are two modes of debate in MUN:

1. Formal Debate

- Includes the General Speakers List (GSL)

2. Informal Debate

- Moderated Caucus
- Unmoderated Caucus

Moderated Caucus (Mod Caucus)

A Moderated Caucus allows delegates to discuss specific sub-topics of the agenda in greater depth.

When raising the motion, delegates must specify:

- Total duration
- Speaker time
- Topic of discussion

A Moderated Caucus requires a **simple majority** to pass.

If a delegate finishes early, the remaining time automatically yields to the Chair.

If no delegates wish to speak, the committee returns to the GSL.

Motion to Enter a Moderated Caucus

Verbatim:

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to suspend formal debate and enter into a Moderated Caucus on the topic ‘_____’ for a total time period of _____ with each speaker getting _____.”

Example:

“The delegate of the United States would like to raise a motion to suspend formal debate and enter into a Moderated Caucus on the topic ‘Human Rights Violations in Syria’ for a total time period of 15 minutes with each speaker getting 60 seconds.”

Notes:

1. Total time must be perfectly divisible by speaker time.
2. Individual speaker time in a Mod Caucus cannot exceed the GSL speaker time.

Unmoderated Caucus (Un-Mod)

An Unmoderated Caucus is an informal lobbying session where delegates freely discuss the agenda with one another.

- Delegates may use first-person pronouns during Un-Mods.
- Maximum duration is generally 30 minutes.

Motion to Enter an Unmoderated Caucus

Verbatim:

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to suspend formal debate and enter into an Unmoderated Caucus for a time period of _____.”

Points

Points allow delegates to communicate with the Executive Board regarding concerns, clarifications, or procedural matters

Point of Personal Privilege

Raised when a delegate experiences discomfort affecting participation (temperature, audibility, etc.).

Example:

“Point of Personal Privilege.”

Point of Order

Used to point out:

- Procedural errors
- Breach of ROPs
- Factual inaccuracies

Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

Used to ask questions regarding committee procedure or rules.

Example:

Asking about position in the speakers list.

Point of Information (POI)

Allows delegates to question another delegate after their speech to seek clarification or challenge arguments.

Yields

Yields occur when a delegate gives away their remaining speaking time during the GSL.

Yield to Another Delegate

A delegate may give remaining time to another delegate, provided the other delegate has agreed beforehand.

Yield to the Executive Board

The Chair decides how to use the remaining time.

Yield to Points of Information

Remaining time is used for delegates to ask questions to the speaker.

Voting

There are two types of voting:

Procedural Voting

Used for committee procedures and motions.

- No abstentions allowed
- Observers may vote
- Requires simple majority ($\frac{1}{2} + 1$)

Substantive Voting

Used for:

- Draft Resolutions
- Amendments
- Official documents

Delegates may:

- Vote in favour
- Vote against
- Abstain

Delegates marked “Present and Voting” cannot abstain.

Requires a **2/3rd majority** to pass.

Motion to Suspend Formal Debate

Verbatim:

“The delegate of _____ would like to raise a motion to suspend formal debate.”

Glossary & Important Terms

1. Formal Session

The most structured form of committee debate.

2. Delegate

A representative of a country in committee.

3. Placard

A board displaying the country’s name.

4. Chairs

The Executive Board members facilitating debate.

5. Decorum

Order and discipline within committee.

6. Roll Call

Attendance-taking procedure.

7. Speakers List

The ordered list of speakers in debate.

8. Motion

A proposal made by delegates to direct committee procedure.

9. Order of Disruption

Determines which motion is voted upon first based on how disruptive it is.

10. Suspension of a Session

Temporary pause in committee proceedings.

11. Adjournment of a Meeting

Ends the committee meeting completely.

12. Adjournment of Debate

Ends discussion on a specific matter.

13. Blocs

Groups of countries sharing similar opinions or interests.

DIRECTIVES

Directives are something unique to a Crisis Committee. These are used to allow a country or nation to perform actions throughout committee. They are written in the form of a note and are used in many instances.

It is unique because unlike other committees, a Directive allows activity to take place. Actions are allowed to be conducted by nations throughout the course of the committee itself which in turn influences the crisis and the task at hand.

In the context of the Continuous Crisis Committee (CCC), directives serve as essential mechanisms for delegates to navigate and respond to the complexities of ongoing events in real time. They empower nations to make strategic decisions, such as:

- Deploying military forces
- Initiating diplomatic discussions
- Enforcing economic sanctions

directly impacting the evolving situation.

For instance, in a scenario centered around the USS Pueblo, delegates may issue directives to mobilize naval fleets or establish alliances to bolster their positions, thereby altering the trajectory of the crisis.

Moreover, the iterative nature of directives allows for a fluid and dynamic interaction between countries, reflecting the historical nuances of international relations. Each directive not only addresses immediate concerns but also influences the broader context of the crisis, making the CCC a unique platform for exploring the intricate interplay of historical decision-making and its ramifications.

TYPES OF DIRECTIVES

There are 3 types of Directives:

1. Action Orders
2. Press Releases
3. Communiqué

1. ACTION ORDERS

An Action Order allows a nation to commence or perform an action with respect to the crisis at hand.

It allows nations to:

- Issue searches
- Declare notices
- Commence attacks
- Grant funding and loans
- Prepare for infiltrations
- Strengthen the military

etc.

Action Orders are of 3 types:

a) Individual Directive

This type of directive is issued by a single delegate to perform a specific sequence of actions.

He sends this to commence actions by himself, without the aid or assistance of another bilateral nation.

He can either make the directive secret or public depending on the importance and critical information the directive contains.

Example:

Individual Directive – Covert

From – Delegate of the United States of America

To – Commander of the USS Bronstein

Sail 50 nautical miles North West from current position and standby beyond Iranian territorial waters. Do not engage hostile frigates until ordered or until fired upon.

Individual Directive – Overt

From – Delegate of Iraq

To – Air Force Commander in Chief

Cease all sorties towards Khorramshahr and return all Su 20 and Mig 21 aircrafts towards their home bases. Iraq is now ready to move into a ceasefire at the border near Khorramshahr for a cessation of hostilities.

b) Joint Directive

This type of directive allows a couple of nations to issue actions together in collaboration with each other.

This directive is used to perform joint activities to make a bigger impact on committee and the course of the crisis.

Example:

From – Delegate of the Islamic Republic of Iran and Republic of Korea

To – The Chief of the IRI Air Force and the Commander in Chief of the Armed Forces of the Republic of Korea

Prepare for the transfer of F-4 Phantom spares to the IRI Air Force in accordance with erstwhile deals and negotiations.

c) Committee Wide Directive

This type of directive is usually issued by the entire committee as a whole who want to take a specific action as a unit.

It is used when the committee wants to take a joint action together.

This hence includes all countries in the committee as each and every country is liable for the actions reflected by the directive itself.

2. PRESS RELEASES

This directive is used by nations to issue a statement or comment regarding a particular incident that took place in the international community.

It does not do anything as such but does represent that country's stance or position with regard to that incident.

It is usually released by the news agency of that particular nation to respond to an international incident or happening.

Example:

The Union of Soviet Socialist Republics

The Soviet Union wishes to inform the international community that while staying in the sphere of both legality and legitimacy, we take it completely on ourselves and on our comprehension of the ongoing conflict between these two nations to analyze what kind of actions can be carried out and why.

No comment is being made about any kind of support to either belligerent but the fact remains that the Soviet Union will indeed respond if it feels that its interests are being affected directly or indirectly.

3. COMMUNIQUÉ

A communiqué is a final working paper for a Crisis Committee.

Just like a resolution, there can be multiple communiqués with multiple blocs.

There are 3 authors to a communiqué.

It is not as legally incremented with facts of international law and conventions and resolutions as other committees are but it contains a series of actions and responses that the committee will take in order to respond to the crisis at hand.

It also can contain various intricacies with regards to the use of past conventions and treaties but it is usually not as detailed and descriptive as a resolution but comprehensive just the same.

It contains clauses and sub clauses depending on the inclusion of the same.

It is used to immediately tackle the situation at hand and respond immediately to ensure geopolitical stability in the world community at the fastest rate of time.

Communiqués can also be used as a means of communication between a delegate and another head of state, should the delegate deem it imperative for the efficient tackling of the crisis.

IMPORTANT NOTE

Delegates, this guide merely gives you some insight into the agenda and it is this point from which your real research starts. Please do note that your research should be both extensive and intensive for it shall have a considerable effect on how you fare in committee and shall be significant in showing how you, as a representatives of your respective nations grasp this agenda and are able to make the most out of it. However, do remember delegates that a MUN Conference is also about fostering new friendships and forming new bonds. You develop yourself not only as better listeners and speakers but also as exemplary individuals who do their part as integral members of modern society. You have a lot to research, a lot to deliberate on, a lot of discussions to engage in and a lot to learn, for learning never stops. I hope you have a fun filled productive three days.

All the very best.